

SUBMACHINE-GUNS (1966–PRESENT)

In this period, some of the guns took on a futuristic look that almost masked their real purpose. The ability to conceal a gun became a prime factor in their construction. Consequently, many submachine-guns were little larger than pistols so that police SWAT and military personnel could carry them beneath civilian clothing. Heckler and Koch’s MP5 (see p.257) is probably one of the most iconic submachine-guns produced at this time, and it has been employed in more than 40 countries. It gave way to the MP7 seen here.



▲ STEYR MPI 81

Date	1990s
Origin	Austria
Barrel	10¼in (26cm)
Caliber	9mm Parabellum

The MPI 81 has a conventional cocking handle that allows the bolt to be manually drawn rearward to cock the gun. This gun is a 9mm recoil-operated weapon with fire selection via trigger pressure—light pressure fires single shots while heavy pressure produces automatic fire, shooting 700 rounds per minute.



▲ SKORPION VZ83

Date	1990s
Origin	Czechoslovakia
Barrel	4½in (11.5cm)
Caliber	9mm Kurz

The Skorpion VZ61 (see p.273) was modified following its introduction to accept larger cartridges, including 9mm Kurz and 9mm Parabellum, but did not go into production. In the 1990s, the rechambered versions were introduced officially. The version using the 9mm Kurz cartridge was called the VZ83.



Retractable butt

Pistol grip